

stock estimation, although “foreign born” criteria is not very popular. Regular household-based labour force surveys conducted by Rosstat as a rule are not used for migration research purposes.

Census. The last Soviet Census was conducted in 1989 and the next census for the RFP was planned for 1999. Due to financial and organizational considerations the census was delayed till 2002. Therefore it was a thirteen-year interval between two censuses. Microcensus that was carried out in 1994, covered 5 % of population and to a certain extent helped fill the gap in information: we could observe basic trends in international migration and collect data on migrants composition and reasons for their move. It was the first time that a question about reason for move was included into a census questionnaire³ (although it was a Microcensus). Besides traditional reasons for moving like job and education, it included such reasons as increase in crime, aggravation of ethnic conflicts, necessity to speak the titular ethnic group language. These helped to describe better the motivation for international migration in the first half of 1990s. (Later some of these reasons were included into the primary forms which are used as a basis of Rosstat data on migration flows).

The last All-Russia Census was held in October 2002. A set of migration related questions was included in the questionnaire: place of birth, citizenship; Russian language abilities⁴; other languages abilities; ethnicity; period of uninterrupted residence in the settlement (reside since birth or not, if not – since what year, if since 1989-2002, where resided in January 1989- region and type of settlement – rural or urban). No questions were devoted to reason for move of parents’ background.

The Census gave an opportunity to apply two main approaches to *definition of migrants stock* - either by citizenship (1455304 persons or 1 % of RF residents were foreigners), or by place of birth (11976822 persons were born outside of the RF, or 8.3%). (Although it is difficult to agree that USSR citizens who moved to RF before the dissolution of the USSR are international migrants).

Table 1. Basic categories for migrant stock and ethnic composition estimation in RF (RF Census 2002 data)

	RF	Not RF	Russian	Other
Place of birth	131608720	11976822		
Citizenship	142442404	1455304		
Ethnicity			115889107	27816873
Language abilities			142573285	1337545

However we must emphasize that ethnicity criterion could hardly be used for migrant stock estimation as RF has always been a multi-ethnic country.

³ The formulations were as follows: education continuation, place of work change, impossibility to get a job, impossibility to go in for agriculture (farming) as a self employed worker, impossibility to go in for own business, ethnic relations aggravation, obligatory knowledge of titular ethnic group language, increase in crime, poor living conditions, unsatisfactory climate, unsatisfactory ecology, Chernobyl nuclear power station catastrophe consequences, unwillingness to live in urban (rural) area, family circumstances, other reason.

⁴ The question did not imply assessment of the level of proficiency in Russian, respondent just had to answer whether he or she knew Russian language.